



After your permit is issued

The permit isn't the finish line. Here's what keeps the approval valid through the build and after it.

DURING THE BUILD

- ✓ **Build what was approved.** The permit covers the stamped plans and nothing else. Keep a copy on site, and check the permit for conditions — some councils add their own.
- ✓ **Change of plan? Stop and amend.** Moved it, enlarged it, swapped the engineering — lodge an amendment with us (the portal's *Amend* page) and a **BA19** with the council *before* the change is built. Amending on paper is quick; retrofitting an approval around as-built work is not.
- ✓ **Watch the clock.** A building permit has a limited life (commonly two years — the date is printed on it). If the build won't finish in time, apply to the council to extend *before* it lapses.

WHEN THE WORK IS FINISHED

- ✓ Give the council a **notice of completion (BA13)** within **7 days** of finishing — it's the builder's obligation under the Building Act, and the form is on our *Resources* page.
- ✓ If the permit carries conditions — retaining certification, an engineer's inspection, final details — close them out and keep the paperwork.
- ✓ **Pools and spas:** the barrier obligation is permanent. Your local government inspects on an ongoing cycle (at least every four years in WA) — see note 09.

KEEP YOUR RECORDS

Save the whole package — certificate, stamped plans, engineering, permit and completion notice. It's what a future buyer's settlement agent, an insurer, or the council will ask for, years after everyone's memory has faded. Your issued documents stay downloadable in the portal for **three months** after first download, then they're removed — so file them with the job, not "later".

The call we get most: "the build changed a bit — is that a problem?" It's only a problem if the paperwork never catches up. Ring us the day the change is contemplated and it's usually a same-week fix.

